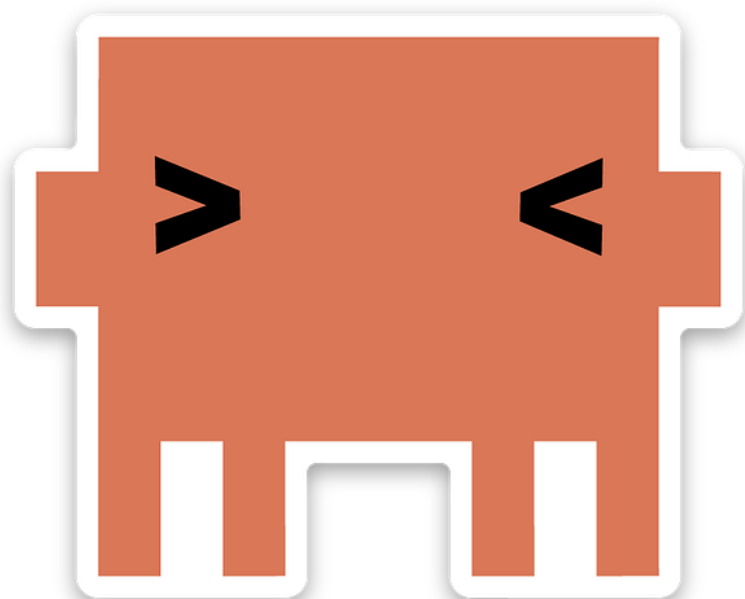




2026 Cornell Claude Builders Club Hackathon

General Information Document

April 25th, 2026, 10AM – 8PM
Collegetown eHub

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Quick Links

Hackathon Links

- **GroupMe:** https://groupme.com/join_group/114462104/YJQMEJn
- **Devpost:** <https://2026-claude-hackathon.devpost.com/>

Cornell Claude Builders Club Links

- **Slack:** https://join.slack.com/t/cornellclaude-suc1909/shared_invite/zt-3w1fspqaf-0AZMbljUvUBSIARc3gh6Q
- **Instagram:** <https://www.instagram.com/claudeatcornell/>
- **Website:** <https://cornellclaude.club/>

Resource Links

- **Claude API Documentation:** <https://platform.claude.com/docs/en/home>
- **Anthropic Academy:** <https://www.anthropic.com/learn>

Contact Information

If you have any questions before or during the event and can't find us, please reach out to a member of the Cornell Claude Builders Club eBoard on **GroupMe** or **Slack**. You can also use the names and photos below to locate us during the hackathon!



Kalia Cheung
Co-President



Christina Joseph
Co-President



Vivian Ren
Senior Advisor



Katie Xiao
Treasurer



Clément Rozé
DEI Chair



Ryan Qiu
Website Chair



Himani Agarwal
Marketing Chair



Ethan Yang
Outreach Chair



Adeeb Khan
Hackathon Chair

Mentors and volunteers will be available throughout the day to help with technical issues and general support.

Schedule

Time	Information
10:00AM – 10:30AM	Registration & Setup - Check-in with the event organizers - Meet fellow participants and finalize teams - Enjoy breakfast catered by Paris Baguette!
10:30AM – 11:00AM	Opening Ceremony - Introduction of the Cornell Claude Builders Club organizers and its partner organizations - Meet your judges and learn about judging criteria - Theme reveal and rules overview - Resources walkthrough (Anthropic Academy, Claude API documentation, Devpost, event slack, etc.) - Quick-start demo: Getting started with Claude API
11:00AM – 11:15AM	Team Formation Finalization - Last change for team adjustments (2-4 people per team) - Final Q&A before hacking begins
11:15AM – 12:30PM	Hacking Session 1
12:30PM – 1:30PM	Lunch: Dos Amigos
1:30PM – 4:00PM	Hacking Session 2
4:00PM – 4:15PM	Mid-Event Check-In - Reminder about final submission requirements
4:15PM – 6:00PM	Hacking Session 3 (Final Sprint)
6:00PM – 6:15PM	Submission Deadline
6:15PM – 7:00PM	Dinner: Franco's Pizza - Judges will review Devpost submissions during this time - Prepare for finalist presentations
7:00PM – 7:30PM	Finalist Presentations - Top 5 teams will present 3-minute live demos to judges
7:30PM – 7:45PM	Final Judging & Winner Selection
7:45PM – 8:00PM	Awards Ceremony & Closing

We will also have mini events throughout the day featuring sponsored snacks and other goodies!

General Information

- Check-in begins at 10:00AM at **Collegetown eHub** (409 College Ave, Ithaca, NY 14850)
- Teams must be 2-4 members and finalized by 11:15AM
- The Hackathon theme will be announced during the Opening Ceremony
- Join the **GroupMe** for updates and announcements throughout the day; this will be our primary method of communication
- Final submissions are due on **Devpost** between 6:00-6:15PM
 - o This is a hard deadline; late or incomplete submissions will **not** be accepted

Hackathon Theme: Social Impact

Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei wrote an essay titled "[Machines of Loving Grace](#)" about a future in which AI helps eliminate disease, expand opportunity, strengthen democracy, and help people find meaning. As Claude Builder Club members, you have the opportunity to play a role in making this future a reality.

Submissions should adhere to **one of the five focus areas** below and demonstrate how AI can meaningfully improve human well-being while engaging with important ethical questions.

- 1.) **Biology & Physical Health** - Make healthcare more accessible or help people manage physical health
- 2.) **Neuroscience & Mental Health** - Expand access to mental health support and understanding
- 3.) **Economic Empowerment & Education** - Remove barriers to learning and opportunity
- 4.) **Governance & Collaboration** - Help people participate in democracy or work together better
- 5.) **Creative Flourishing** - Amplify human creativity and help people find meaning

Submission Requirements

- All projects must be submitted through the official Devpost page
- Submissions must include:
 - o A completed Devpost project page (with all team members added)
 - o A **public** GitHub repository with all source code
 - o A README.md with project description and setup instructions
 - o A demo video (under 60 seconds)
 - o Documentation of the tech stack used
 - o A description of challenges faced and how they were addressed
- Please ensure **all attached links are working and accessible** (hackathon organizers cannot help with updating links after the submission period is over)

Winner Selection Process

- All complete Devpost submissions will be reviewed by our panel of judges
- Judges will select the **Top 5 Finalists** (announced at 7:00PM)
- Finalists will present a 3-minute live demo followed by 1 minute of Q&A
 - o We recommend using the allotted dinner time (6:15PM – 7:00PM) to prepare your demo in case your team is selected
- Final winners will be selected based on their live demo, responses during Q&A, and Devpost submission

Judging Criteria

Criteria	Guiding Question(s)
Impact Potential	- Does this solve a real problem? - Who benefits and how? - Could it scale?
Technical Execution	- Does it work? - Is it well-built? - Effective use of AI?
Ethical Alignment	- Centers human dignity? - Addresses potential harms? - Expands access equitably?
Presentation	- Can you clearly explain what you built and why it matters?

Prizes

Placement	Prize(s)	# of Winners
1 st Place	- \$750 in Claude API Credits - Exclusive, custom-designed Claude trophy	1
2 nd Place	- \$500 in Claude API Credits - Exclusive, custom-designed Claude trophy	1
3 rd Place	- \$250 in Claude API Credits - Exclusive, custom-designed Claude trophy	1
Finalist	- Exclusive, custom-designed Claude trophy	2